

the time spent by counsel into the trial court's reasonableness determination; as such, it is not likely to radically alter the incentives created by a court's use of the percentage method. *Laffitte v. Robert Half Internat. Inc.* (2016) 1 Cal. 5th 480, 505.

“Multipliers can range from 2 to 4 or even higher.” *Wershba v. Apple Computer, Inc.* (2001) 91 Cal. App. 4th 224, 255 (overruled on other grounds in *Hernandez v. Restoration Hardware, Inc.* (2018) 4 Cal. 5th 260). *Wershba* cited two cases for the quoted sentence. The first is *Coalition for L.A. County Planning Etc. Interest v. Board of Supervisors* (1977) 76 Cal. App. 3d 241 where the approved attorney fees yielded a multiplier of 2.04. The second case cited by *Wershba* is *Arenson v. Board of Trade* (Ill. N. D. 1974) 372 F. Supp. 1349 which did not include a lodestar cross check and instead focused on a reasonable attorneys’ fee in a massive and landmark antitrust lawsuit. In setting the attorneys’ fee, the court wrote, “This Court's award of four times the hourly rate of the plaintiffs' attorneys is meant to adequately compensate them for initiating this significant litigation and negotiating such a beneficial settlement for the class; yet at the same time this award is not meant to provide a windfall to the plaintiffs' attorneys.” *Id.* at 1359. This is where the multiplier of 4 stems from. This Court did significant research to determine if a multiplier of 6 has ever been approved and was unable to locate such a case. Most cases reviewed were in the range of 1.5 to 2.

The Court finds that awarding the requested fee of \$385,000 when the evidence provided by Plaintiff shows only \$63,422.50 in actual legal work is not in the interest of justice. This is amplified by the rates being listed for counsel being set at \$925 and \$625 per hour with either no or very little evidence for the reasonableness of these rates. The Court notes that no objections were received, however, the Court also notes that the Class Notice provided no indication that the lodestar was so low in comparison to the requested fee.

The Court finds that a multiplier of 3 is fair and reasonable under the circumstances. This fairly and adequately compensates Class Counsel without it amounting to a windfall. A multiplier of 3 results in the following final breakdown of the settlement.

Total Settlement Amount	\$1,100,000.00
Proposed Attorneys’ Fees	-\$190,267.50
Litigation Costs and Expenses	-\$25,848.51
Settlement Administration Costs	-\$9,650.00
Proposed Class Representative Enhancement	-\$7,500.00
PAGA Claim Settlement Allocation	-\$50,000.00
Payment to Labor and Workforce Development Agency (LWDA) (65%)	(\$32,500.00)
Payment to Aggrieved Employees as Individual PAGA payments (35%)	(\$17,500.00)
Remaining to be Disbursed to Class Members and PAGA Employees	\$834,233.99

The motion is **GRANTED** with the modified breakdown provided above. Plaintiff submitted a Proposed Order that will be modified to reflect the Court’s ruling. The Court retains jurisdiction pursuant to CRC 3.769(h). The Court sets the matter on **Monday, April 26, 2027 at 9:00 a.m. in Department 63** for a hearing on compliance. Prior to the hearing, Plaintiff is expected to provide evidence that the settlement checks were mailed, any uncashed checks were transmitted to the State of California Unclaimed Property Fund, and that all fees and costs have been paid as outlined above. Evidence should be filed no later than April 16, 2027.

BAMFORD, ET AL. VS. BURNEY WATER DISTRICT
CASE NUMBER: 24CV-0204809

Tentative Ruling on Order to Show Cause Re: Sanctions: On My 7, 2026, the Court issued an Order to Show Cause Re: Sanctions (OSC) to Guardians ad Litem Artensia Eaton and Lavon Bamford. The OSC was mailed directly to each Guardian ad Litem. The basis for the OSC is that both Guardians ad Litem failed to communicate

with counsel. As to Artensia Eaton, the OSC is **DISCHARGED** as a Petition for Compromise of Claim of Minor was filed on May 22, 2026. The Court notes that this matter was filed on April 17, 2024. The Court further notes that Plaintiff's counsel has moved to be relieved as to Lavon Bamford on three separate occasions based on lack of communication with counsel. Each motion was accompanied by a declaration that was compliant with CCP 2015.5. The Court finds that Lavon Bamford has failed to cooperate in this matter, which has affected her effectiveness as the Guardian ad Litem for her minor children. **An appearance by Lavon Bamford is necessary on today's calendar. Absent an appearance, the Court intends to impose sanctions in the amount of \$250 and issue an Order to Show Cause Re: Termination of Lavon Bamford's status as a Guardian ad Litem.**

Tentative Ruling on Petition to Approve Minor's Compromise: This Petition for Approval of Compromise of Claim for Minor is a settlement of minor Roman Eaton Harris' claims from 2023 against the Burney Water District. The minor's Guardian, Artensia Eaton, was appointed as the minor's Guardian ad Litem on July 9, 2025. The Court notes this is not an expedited petition brought on Judicial Council Form MC-350EX. See CRC Rule 7.950.5. Hearing is thus needed on the Petition before it can be approved. California Rule of Court, Rule 7.950 states that a petition for court approval of a minor's compromise must contain a full disclosure of all information that has any bearing upon the reasonableness of the compromise.

The Petition lacks necessary information. The dollar amounts are missing from Item 11.b.(5). Item 12 was left completely blank, however, in Item 7, Petitioner indicated that the minor was evaluated by a healthcare provider. If there were any medical expenses that require reimbursement, they must be listed. Additionally, Item 12.b.(4) must be completed. This information is required in order to move forward with the Petition.

If counsel is able to provide this information at the hearing, the Court can accept oral testimony from either counsel or Petitioner as to this information then allow voir dire of Petitioner as to the terms of the settlement and whether the Petitioner understands that once approved, the settlement is final and binding on the minor. If satisfied, the Court intends to grant the Petition. If granted, the Court will execute the Orders and schedule a hearing for review regarding confirmation of deposit. If counsel is unable to provide this information, counsel is ordered to appear to set a new hearing date.

IN RE: CLAREY

CASE NUMBER: 26CV-0210037

Tentative Ruling on Petition for Change of Name: Petitioner seeks to change the last name of her minor daughter. The Certificate of Publication was filed on June 2, 2026. When a petition to change the name of a minor is brought by one parent only, the non-petitioning parent must be personally served with the notice of hearing or order to show cause at least 30 days before the hearing date. See CCP § 1277(a)(4). The Proof of Service filed on June 8, 2026 indicates service on June 6, 2026, which is only 23 days prior to the hearing. The non-petitioning parent must have no less than 30 days' notice. The Court intends to set the matter for hearing on **Monday, August 24, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. in Department 63**. Petitioner must obtain an Amended Order to Show Cause for the new hearing date and have the Amended Order to Show Cause personally served on the non-consenting parent no less than 30 days prior to August 24, 2026.

CREDIT CORP SOLUTIONS, INC. VS. COOPER

CASE NUMBER: 25CVG-01439

Tentative Ruling on Order to Show Cause Re: Sanctions: An Order to Show Cause Re: Sanctions in the amount of \$500 issued on May 22, 2026 to Plaintiff Credit Corp Solutions, Inc. and Counsel Patenaude & Felix, APC for failure to appear on May 18, 2026 as ordered on April 9, 2026. Plaintiff provided a written response to the Order to Show Cause and asserts that Plaintiff did not receive notice.

The Court issued two Orders on April 9, 2026, the first vacated the Mandatory Settlement Conference and trial dates (because the matter was not at issue) and the second was an Order to Show Cause as Plaintiff had not timely